



GRIMES COUNTY COMMISSIONERS COURT

OFFICIAL MINUTES — FRIDAY, AUGUST 7, 2026

The Grimes County Commissioners Court met on Friday, August 7, 2026, at 9:00 A.M. Members Present: County Judge Joe Fauth, Commissioner Chad Mallett, Commissioner David Tullos, Commissioner Michael Raska, Commissioner Phillip Cox.

County Judge Joe Fauth called the meeting to order.

1 Consider and take action to propose a tax rate and take a record vote on proposed tax rate. If proposed tax rate will exceed the voter-approval tax rate or the no new revenue tax rate (whichever is lower), take record vote and schedule a public hearing. — Joe Fauth III

County Judge Joe Fauth introduced the discussion of the proposed tax rate, noting that the court had received rate information from GCAD Shannon Sanders. The no new revenue rate was identified as 0.401815 and the voter approval rate as 0.428360, compared to the current rate of 0.423077. Sanders explained that adopting the no new revenue rate would allow the county to recapture foregone revenue over up to three years through unused increment calculations, though she cautioned that the mechanism was complex and dependent on changing property valuations affected by litigation, arbitration, and homestead exemptions. Commissioner David Tullos raised questions about why the no new revenue rate calculations showed a roughly \$500,000 difference in total tax levy compared to the previous year, and Sanders attributed this to constantly changing appraisal rolls, litigation-related adjustments, and other factors that made the no new revenue calculation imperfect. The court discussed procedural matters, including that a proposed rate today would trigger public notices but could be revised downward at adoption, though proposing a lower rate and adopting a higher one was prohibited. Commissioner Chad Mallett noted the time constraints imposed by the certification deadline, budget discussions, and the requirement to file the proposed budget by the following Friday. County Auditor Jessi Murphy explained that the court had a \$2,800,000 deficit in the current budget proposal and indicated that further detailed budget discussions were needed before a final rate decision could be made. The discussion extended at length over the interplay between setting a tax rate as an anchor for budget decisions versus completing budget deliberations first, with commissioners expressing concern about insufficient information regarding departmental needs, salaries for elected officials, ambulance service expansion, and capital projects funded by anticipated payments from SpaceX and TeraFab.

Action: Motion by County Judge Joe Fauth to Propose a tax rate of 0.420000 per \$100 valuation for the 2026-2027 fiscal year. No second.

2 Discussion and action to propose the salary, expenses and other allowances for Grimes County elected officials for the 2026-2027 fiscal year. — Joe Fauth III

County Judge Joe Fauth presented his proposed budget recommendations for salary, expenses, and other allowances for Grimes County elected officials for the 2026-2027 fiscal year, noting he had applied a flat \$4 per hour increase across all county employees as a benchmark for calculation purposes. Commissioner Chad Mallett indicated he was willing to set the rate at the maximum to allow

room for later reduction if needed. County Attorney Megan Barcak clarified the statutory timeline, explaining that the proposed amount would be advertised in the newspaper to meet publication deadlines, with the actual salary grievance process commencing only after the official vote scheduled for the twenty-sixth. County Auditor Jessi Murphy noted that the advertisement would list each elected official's current salary, proposed salary, and post increase, and flagged several adjustments beyond the flat \$4 increase: the county sheriff would receive grant funds exceeding that amount, the court was receiving a 4% increase on travel allowance, and the county attorney was transitioning to full-time status with compensation already budgeted on a different line item. Commissioner Phillip Cox questioned the justification for applying the \$4 figure to elected officials when the original rationale was employee retention, and expressed concern that setting a maximum amount might create expectations among elected officials. Commissioner David Tullos requested a record vote and emphasized the need to clearly state the dollar figures on the public record. The discussion at length covered the distinction between this proposed advertisement and the actual salary-setting process, with commissioners acknowledging this was a preliminary step before further budget deliberations.

Action: Motion by Commissioner Chad Mallett to Approve the proposed salary, expenses, and other allowances for Grimes County elected officials for the 2026-2027 fiscal year as designated in the preliminary budget proposed by the County Judge, with the adjustments proposed for the Sheriff and County Attorney, for purposes of advertisement and publication. Seconded by Commissioner Michael Raska. Carried (3–2–0).

Voting Yea: County Judge Joe Fauth, Commissioner Chad Mallett, Commissioner Michael Raska

Voting Nay: Commissioner David Tullos, Commissioner Phillip Cox

ADJOURNMENT

A motion to adjourn the meeting was made by Commissioner Mallett. Seconded by Commissioner Raska, Motion carried (5-0-0) The meeting adjourned at 10:02 AM.

THE OFFICIAL MINUTES OF THE GRIMES COUNTY COMMISSIONERS COURT ON August 7th, 2026, ARE HEREBY APPROVED.

Barbara Kimich County Clerk